



4 Productive skills: the blog post or article

Productive skills · IB Diploma · Concept guide and original exam-style practice

Understand the concept

Blog posts and articles are more personal and engaging than formal letters: they use a catchy title, a hook opening, short paragraphs or sub-headings, and a conversational though still standard register, often including rhetorical questions or direct address to the reader. Articles inform or explore an issue in a structured way; blog posts are typically more personal, first-person and reflective, often ending with an invitation to comment or share an opinion.

Worked example: follow the reasoning

Title: 'Why I Stopped Scrolling Before Bed'

Opening: Have you ever picked up your phone for 'just five minutes' and looked up an hour later? I used to do this every single night, until one ordinary Tuesday made me rethink my whole evening routine.

Quick check · multiple choice

Which feature is most typical of a personal blog post rather than a formal report?

- A Passive voice throughout
- B First-person, conversational tone with direct address to the reader
- C A numbered list of technical references
- D No title or heading

Write your choice: _____

Structured practice

Answer in the space provided.

- 1 Write a blog post of 250-400 words about a time you tried something completely new and what you learned from the experience. Use an engaging title and a tone that connects with your readers. [25]

Final answer: _____



Answers and explanation

Question 1 [25]

A strong response includes:

- An engaging, relevant title, not simply 'My Blog Post'
- A hook opening: a question, a vivid moment, or a surprising statement
- First-person, conversational register with occasional direct address such as 'you might feel the same way'
- Clear paragraphing following a narrative or reflective arc: the experience, the challenge, the lesson learned
- A concluding thought or invitation for readers to reflect or comment
- Varied sentence structure and a natural, engaging tone rather than a stiff, formal one
- Word count within 250-400 words

Quick check answer

B. Blog posts favour a personal, first-person voice that engages the reader directly.

Self-assessment

Compare each credited step with your own answer. Fix the first reasoning or content error, then retry the practice question without looking at the solution.

Based on the IB English B guide (2018).

Original FagusED teaching material. Not an official IB publication; the sample scenarios and language are invented and generic.